

Wyoming 2026 Primary Candidate Rubric

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Source checksum: cbf458344636d5e8df23805ca2b802a5376ff324695f32e3131fa121859f5994

Score range: 0-5. Missing evidence: Unknown and excluded from scoring.

Weights total 100. Maximum fully evidenced weighted score: 500.

1. Constitutional oath and rule of law (weight 15)

Standard: Evaluate respect for constitutional limits, the oath of office, due process, and the lawful roles of the legislative, executive, and judicial branches. Distinguish disagreement with a ruling from documented attempts to evade controlling law or the constitutional amendment process.

Evidence: Prefer constitutional text, court records, enacted legislation, recorded votes, official statements, and direct candidate explanations. Do not infer intent from party membership or association alone.

2. Character, honesty, and courage (weight 15)

Standard: Evaluate documented truthfulness, consistency between statements and conduct, willingness to correct errors, treatment of others, and willingness to take accountable public positions under pressure.

Evidence: Use attributable public conduct, corrections, official findings, direct statements, and corroborated reporting. Do not score rumor, anonymous accusation, or disagreement over policy as a character defect.

3. Competence and readiness (weight 10)

Standard: Evaluate demonstrated understanding of the office, relevant responsibilities, preparation, judgment, and the ability to explain how proposed actions could be lawfully and practically carried out.

Evidence: Consider relevant work, public service, legislative or administrative performance, debates, detailed proposals, and direct answers. Do not require prior elected office.

4. Accountability and transparency (weight 10)

Standard: Evaluate disclosure, responsiveness, explanation of decisions, compliance with reporting duties, correction of material errors, and willingness to provide voters with verifiable information.

Evidence: Prefer required filings, public records, correction history, direct responses, meeting records, and documented patterns of disclosure or nondisclosure.

5. Fiscal responsibility (weight 10)

Standard: Evaluate whether the candidate's record and proposals identify costs, funding sources, tradeoffs, long-term obligations, and responsible stewardship of public money.

Evidence: Use budgets, fiscal notes, recorded votes, campaign finance filings, audits, detailed proposals, and direct explanations. Do not treat wealth, poverty, or a disclosed contribution as proof of fiscal character.

6. Local impact and Wyoming fit (weight 10)

Standard: Evaluate understanding of Wyoming communities, constitutional and jurisdictional

boundaries, and the likely local effects of the candidate's record or proposals on land, water, energy, agriculture, families, and local government.

Evidence: Prefer Wyoming-specific proposals, local records, public meetings, constituent work, impact analysis, and direct explanations rather than national talking points alone.

7. Public service over self-interest (weight 10)

Standard: Evaluate documented service, stewardship, conflicts management, use of public responsibility, and whether conduct demonstrates attention to constituents and public obligations rather than personal benefit alone.

Evidence: Use service records, ethics disclosures, conflict documentation, constituent work, official findings, and corroborated conduct. A disclosed interest is not misconduct by itself.

8. Issue alignment with Skovgard 2026 (weight 10)

Standard: Compare the candidate's documented positions and record with Jimmy Skovgard's published platform priorities. This category is explicitly perspective-specific and must not be presented as a neutral measure of candidate quality.

Evidence: Use current published platforms, direct statements, recorded votes, and detailed proposals. Mark changed or unclear positions and do not infer alignment where no evidence exists.

9. Coalition-building and temperament (weight 5)

Standard: Evaluate demonstrated ability to work through disagreement, communicate responsibly, build effective support, and maintain principled but functional relationships required by the office.

Evidence: Use legislative or organizational outcomes, public forums, direct working relationships, attributable conduct, and corroborated reporting. Style alone is not evidence of effectiveness or failure.

10. Evidence quality (weight 5)

Standard: Evaluate the authority, freshness, completeness, independence, and corroboration of the evidence available for the candidate. This category describes the research record, not the candidate's ideology.

Evidence: Higher scores require multiple fresh, direct, authoritative sources. Sparse, stale, indirect, or internally conflicting evidence lowers this score and must also be disclosed through evidence coverage.